

NWS Heat Alerting and Messaging in South Florida

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Heat Alerts and Messaging

- **Heat is a leading weather-related killer in South Florida, with potentially dangerous levels of “chronic heat” 4-5 months of the year**
- **Enhanced social media and core partner briefing strategy for advisory AND sub-advisory days in which there is a threat of heat illness/death**

NWS Heat Alerts and Messaging

- **Heat Advisory/Warning Thresholds lowered to 105F/110F for Miami-Dade County.** Unchanged (108F/113F) for the rest of the NWS Miami service area
- Consideration given to the average frequency of specific heat index values to try avoiding “warning fatigue”

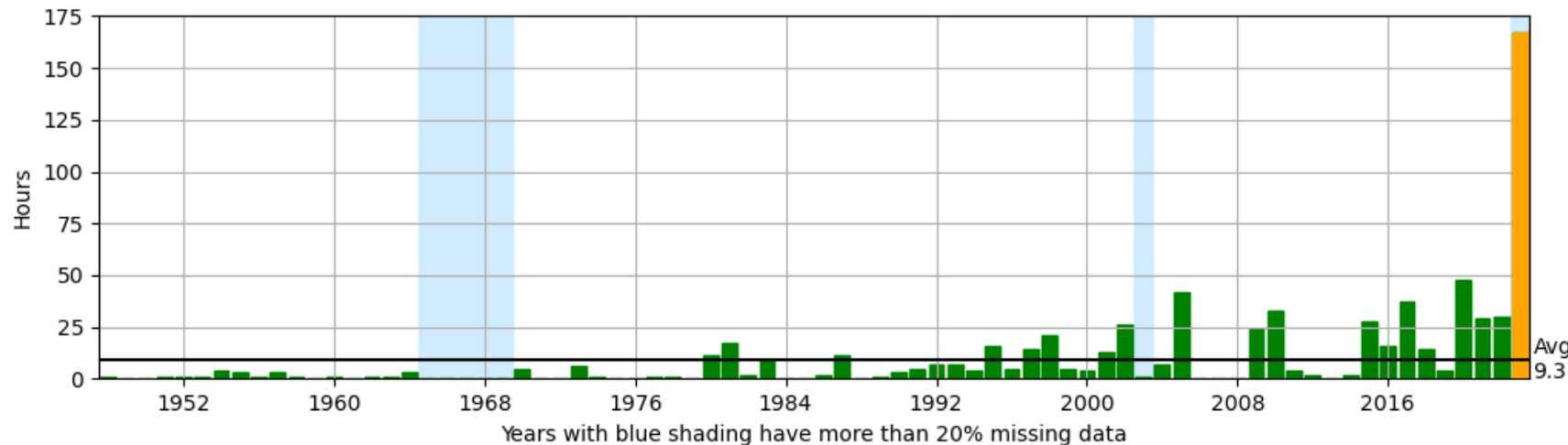
Hours with Heat Index $\geq 105^{\circ}\text{F}$



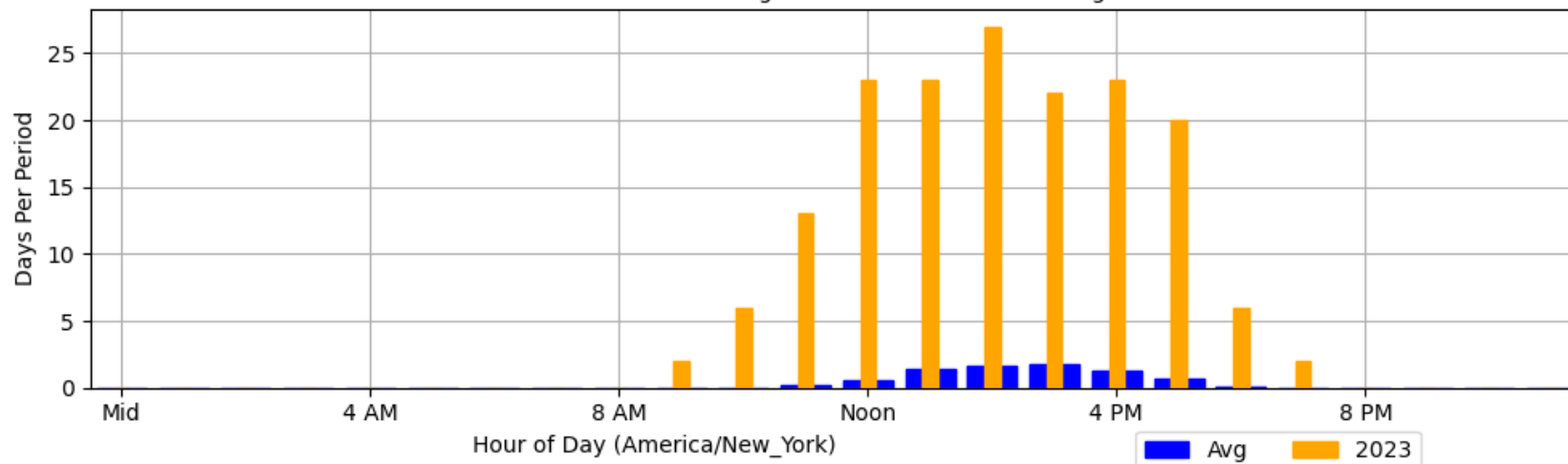
Miami
WEATHER FORECAST OFFICE



(No Month/Time Limit) Feels Like Temp (F) Hours At or Above 105F
[MIA] MIAMI INTL AIRPORT:: (1948-2023)



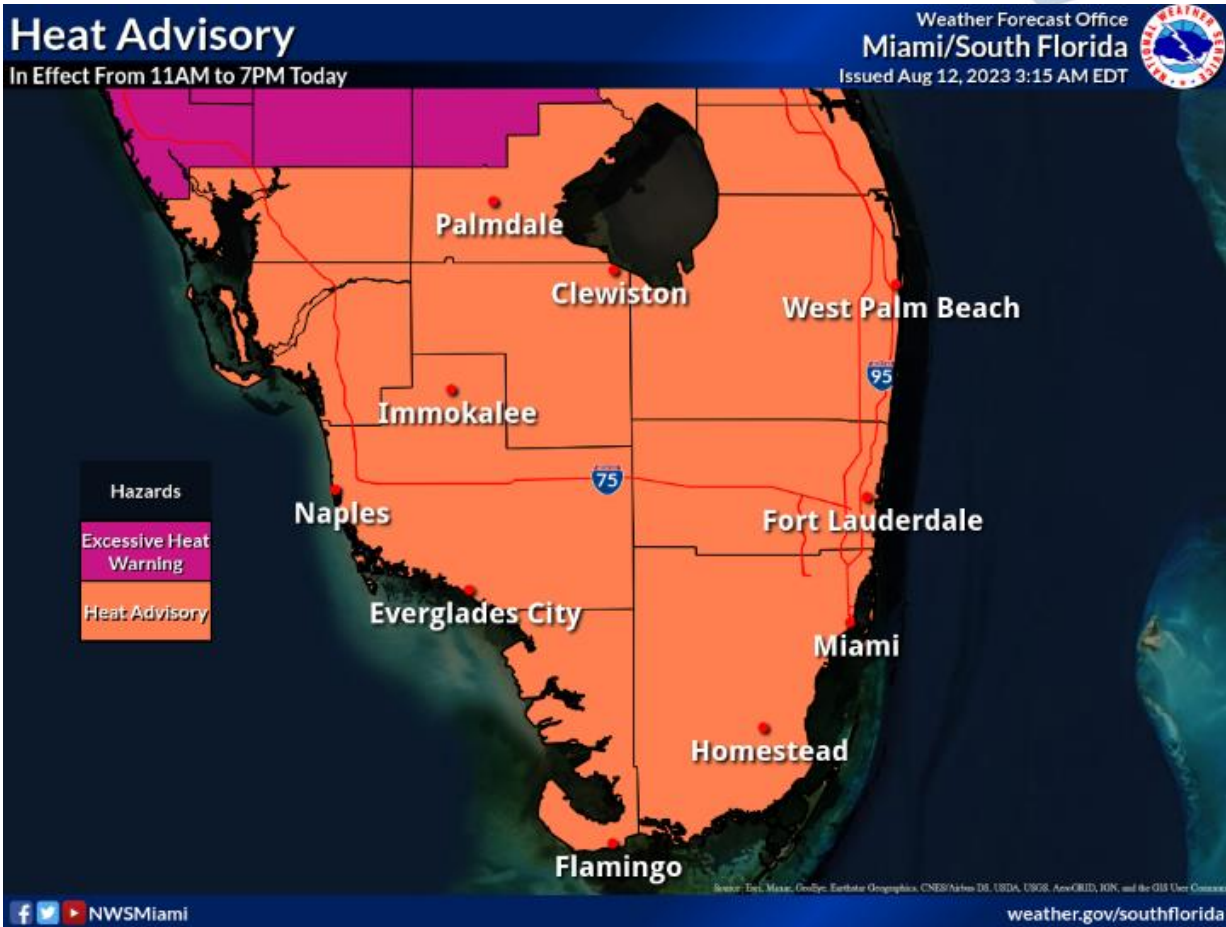
- Record heat in 2023



NWS Heat Alerts and Messaging

- **Evaluation of program after the heat season** to assess feasibility of the new thresholds and enhanced messaging strategy
- Compare health data to observed temperatures and heat alerts
- Effectiveness and impact of messaging
- “Too many” heat advisories and warnings?
- **Public response to new thresholds is KEY!**

Enhanced Messaging



STAY INDOORS DURING HEAT WAVES



Stay indoors in **air conditioning** whenever possible. If your home doesn't have AC, check if your area has a cooling center.



Remain hydrated by drinking **water** and avoiding alcohol.



Check on those **most vulnerable** to heat, including children and the elderly.



If you must go outdoors, go early or late in the day, and dress in light-colored clothing.



weather.gov



**Graphics posted on social
media (Facebook/Twitter &
weather.gov/miami**

Briefings to Media and EM/Public Safety Partners



National Weather Service
Miami - South Florida

Heat Advisory in Effect for Miami-Dade, Broward, and Collier Today

Weather Overview

- Heat indices will range from 105F - 110F late this morning through mid afternoon across far Southern Florida.
- Heat Advisory has been issued from 10 AM until 5 PM for Miami-Dade, Broward, and Collier counties.
- Heat advisories could be expanded northward if early afternoon convection around the lake and Palm Beach doesn't materialize.

Resources

[NWS Miami/South Florida Webpage](#)

[Hourly Forecasts \(Click Your Location\)](#)

[Point Forecast Page](#)

[South Florida Hazardous Weather Outlook](#)

[NWS Miami/South Florida Tropical Webpage](#)

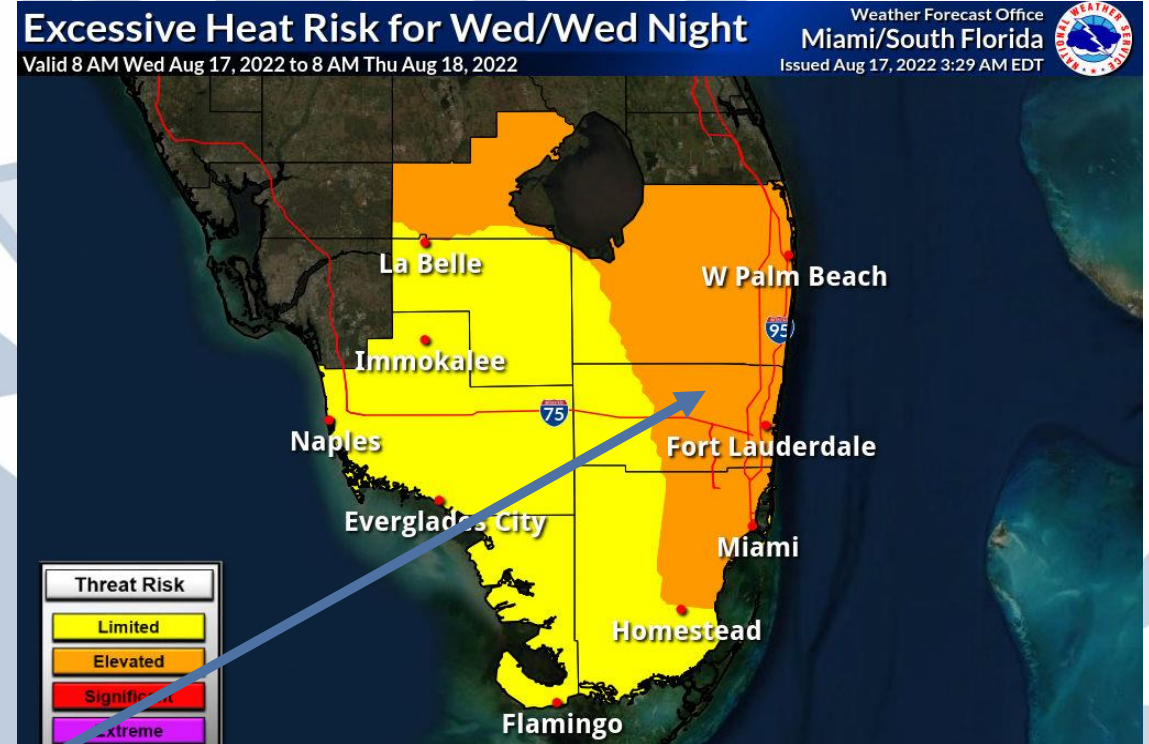
[National Hurricane Center Webpage](#)

Contact

Briefing packages sent on days with Heat Advisory or Excessive Heat Warning

Heat Alerts and Messaging

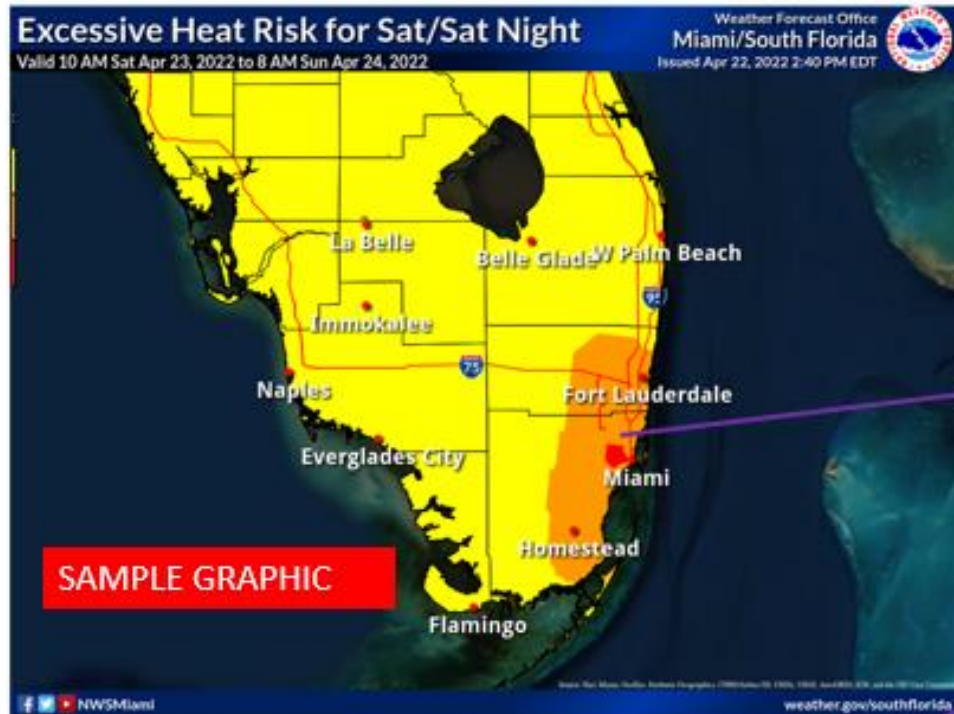
- Hazardous Weather Outlook risk categories can play a role in **supporting community decisions/actions**



Risk Level	Category	Definition
	None	No Excessive Heat Risk.
	Limited	Limited Excessive Heat Risk. Heat index 98-102 degrees. Heat exhaustion possible with prolonged exposure.
	Elevated	Elevated Excessive Heat Risk. Heat index 103-107 degrees. Heat exhaustion likely with prolonged exposure.
	Significant	Significant Excessive Heat Risk. Heat index 108-112 degrees. Dangerous and potentially deadly heat stroke likely with prolonged exposure.
	Extreme	Extreme Excessive Heat Risk. Heat index 113 degrees or higher. Dangerous and potentially deadly heat stroke likely with limited exposure.

Heat Alerts and Messaging

Graphical Hazardous Weather Outlook Excessive Heat Risk Level Definitions



Public Marine

24 Hr Hazard Risks	Today	Sat	Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu
Severe Thunderstorm	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Tornado	■	■					
Thunderstorm Wind	■	■					
Hail	■	■					
Lightning	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Excessive Rainfall	■	■	■				
Excessive Heat	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Wind	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Frost/Freeze	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Fog	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Fire Weather	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Excessive Cold	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
Waterspout	■						

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Has Lower Alert Thresholds and Enhanced Messaging Made a Difference?

Data from City of Miami Fire Rescue – # of EMS Responses

June: 24 (average MIA temp. 83.7F)

July: 52 (average MIA temp. 86.5F)

August: ? (average MIA temp. 86.6F)

28 EMS responses in August

Acclimation? Messaging Impact?

NEMSIS Surveillance Dashboard



Heat-Related EMS Activation Surveillance Dashboard

August 17, 2023 – September 15, 2023

Dashboard Updated On: September 18, 2023 (Updated Weekly)

Select Time Period: Previous 30 Days
Select Level of Geographic Detail: Counties
Select to View Specific State/District/Territory: (All)
Select Heat-Related: Rate of Heat-Related E

National Statistics

Average EMS Time to Patient

13.0 minutes
% Change +1.9%

Number of Heat-Related EMS Activations

8,394
% Change -35.9%

Rate of Heat-Related EMS Activations per 100K Population

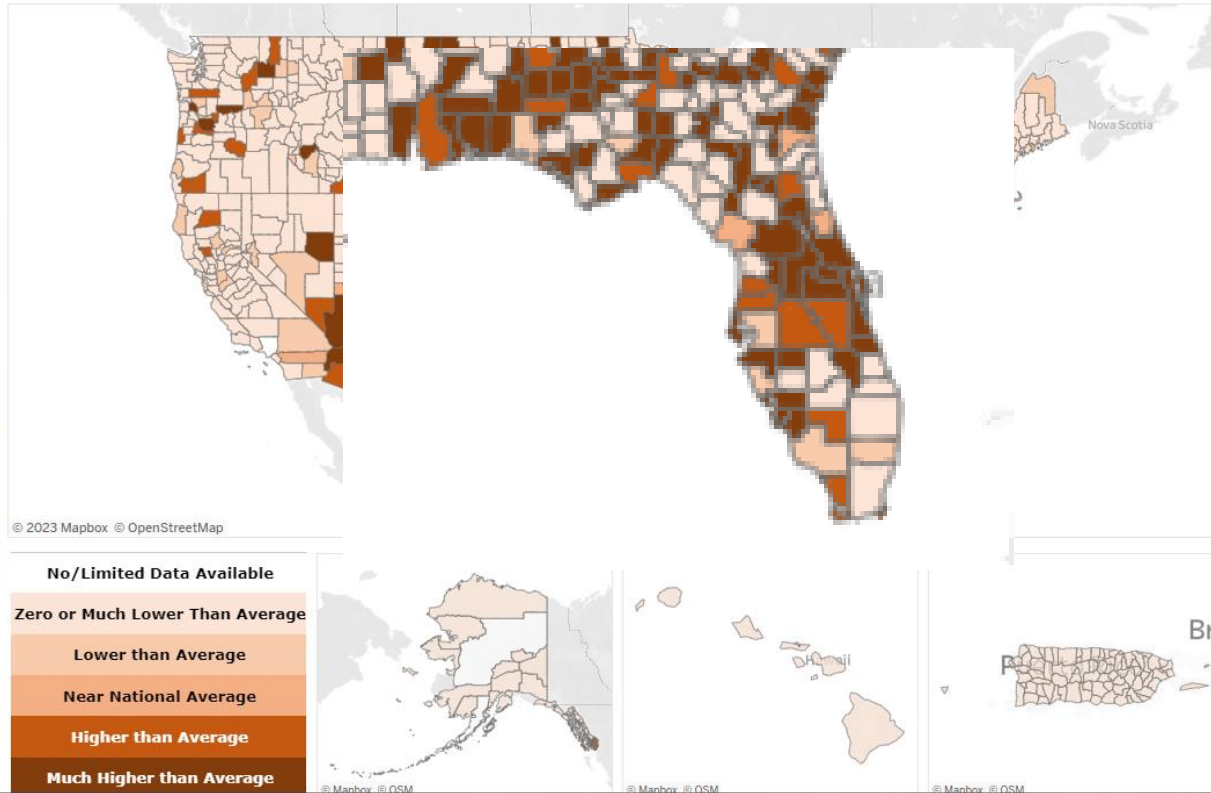
2.5
% Change -35.9%

Number of Heat-Related Deaths Among EMS Activations

19.0
% Change -57.8%

Patients Transported to a Medical Facility

62.8%
% Change -37.2%



No/Limited Data Available

Zero or Much Lower Than Average

Lower than Average

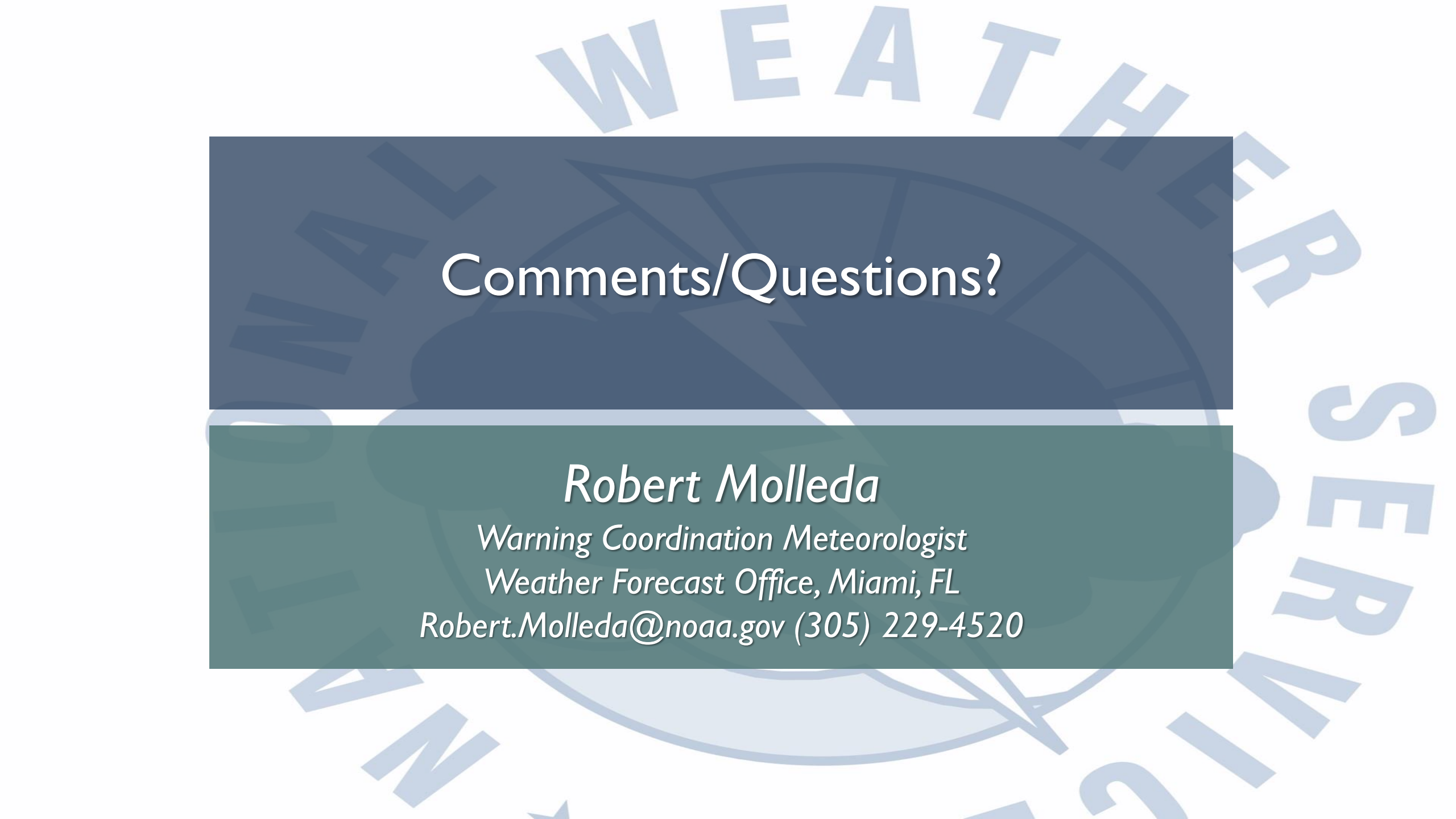
Near National Average

Higher than Average

Much Higher than Average

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) Office of Climate Change and Health Equity (OCCHE), in partnership with the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA)

<https://nemsis.org/heat-related-ems-activation-surveillance-dashboard>



Comments/Questions?

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